

Ardmore Parish Newsletter

Sunday, 28th June 2026

13th Sunday in Ordinary Time.

PARISH BULLETIN

Thoughts on the Gospel

Thirteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time – Matthew 10:37–42

Today's Gospel invites us to reflect deeply on our priorities and to renew our commitment to placing Christ first in every aspect of our lives.

While family, work, relationships and responsibilities are precious gifts, the Gospel reminds us that none of these should take the place of God at the centre of our hearts. When Christ becomes our foundation, our choices, actions and relationships are guided by His wisdom, love and peace.

Following Jesus is a beautiful calling, but it is not always easy. Discipleship often requires choosing faithfulness over comfort and service over self-interest. The sacrifices we make may be unseen by others, but they are never unseen by God. Every quiet act of perseverance becomes part of the cross we carry with Christ, drawing us closer to Him.

The Gospel also reminds us of the power of small acts of kindness. God values not the size of our gift but the love with which it is offered. A gentle word, a listening ear, or a simple gesture of compassion can bring hope to someone in need. No sincere act of generosity is ever wasted.

In a world that often pursues success, recognition or possessions, the Gospel calls us back to our true purpose: **to know, love and serve God, and to help others along the way.** When we live for something greater than ourselves, life gains depth and meaning.

God never overlooks faithfulness. Every act of love, every sacrifice, and every choice to follow Christ is precious in His sight. Even when unnoticed by others, God sees it all. A faithful heart continues to love and serve without seeking recognition.

May we welcome Christ by welcoming others, embrace sacrifice with courage, practise daily kindness, and trust in God's promises. When we live this way, we discover the joy of walking closely with the Lord each day.

A life devoted to God is never lived in vain.

Morning Offering

O Jesus, through the most pure hands of Mary, I offer You all my prayers, works, joys and sufferings of this day, for all the intentions of Thy Sacred Heart. All for Thee, Most Sacred Heart of Jesus, all for Thee.

Pope's Prayer Intention for July

For Grandparents and the Elderly

You are invited to join people throughout the world in praying that members of the Church may always appreciate the treasure of faith and wisdom offered by grandparents and the elderly, and be willing to learn from their experience.

Diocesan Notices

Diocesan Youth Pilgrimage to Fatima

Young people aged **16 years and over** are invited to join the Diocesan Pilgrimage to Fatima from **3rd–8th August**.

This is a unique opportunity to journey in faith and meet young Catholics from around the world.

Cost: £820

Enquiries:

- bethany.doherty@derrydiocese.org
- Tel: 028 7126 4087

Diocese of Derry Pilgrimage to Lough Derg

The Diocese of Derry Three-Day Pilgrimage takes place from **24th–26th July**.

Seventeen pilgrims have already registered, and more are warmly invited to join.

Cost: £95 / €110 (including coach transport)

Contact:

- Tel: 028 7126 2302 (office hours)
- Email: tony.brennan@derrydiocese.org

Walk in Our Patron Saint's Footsteps

Join a guided **St Patrick's Way Pilgrim Walk** in Downpatrick.

Guides

- 4th July – Mairead Sweeney
- 8th August – Martina Purdy & Elaine Kelly

Cost: £55

Includes:

- Coach travel
- Lunch
- Pilgrim Passport
- Six-mile guided pilgrimage

Time: 9.00 am – 3.00 pm

Tel: 028 4461 9000

Website:

www.saintpatrickcentre.com

Silent Retreat

A Silent Retreat preached by **Fr Kilian Byrne (Foyer of Charity)** will take place at **Termonbacca, Derry** from **13th–19th July**.

Cost: £395 / €450 (full board)

For further information contact:

Helen

- 00353 86 1678027
- hellywilliams@gmail.com

Website:

www.foyerofcharity.ie

Reflections Through Poetry

A limited number of copies of "**Reflections Through Poetry**" by **Fr John P. Forbes** are available from the Pastoral Office.

Price: £10

All proceeds will support **Children in Crossfire** and the **Cause for Sr Clare's Canonisation**.

Pray for Vocations

In today's Gospel, Jesus encourages those He is calling to the priesthood not to be afraid to "**take up their cross and follow Him**."

He promises that those who give their lives in His service will discover true fulfilment and life in Him.

For more information visit:

<https://derryvocations.org>

Rally for Life

Those wishing to attend the **Rally for Life, Liberty and Faith** on **Saturday 4th July** at **1.30 pm** in Belfast City Centre may reserve a seat on the parish bus.

For bookings contact **Precious Life**

- 07592 280522
- 028 9027 8484
- info@preciouslife.com

Fr Mike Schmitz – Parables Tour

Derry Youth Ministry invites young people aged **16+** to travel to Dublin on **20th July** for the **Fr Mike Schmitz Parables Tour**.

Fr Mike Schmitz is an American priest and digital evangelist whose engaging style speaks directly to young people today.

The evening includes Mass with young people from across Ireland.

Cost: £45 (ticket and transport)

Bus departs Derry at 12 noon, with pick-ups in Strabane and Omagh.

Contact:

- bethany.doherty@derrydiocese.org
- 028 7126 4087

Concern Derry Group

The Annual **Scalp Challenge** in aid of Concern's worldwide development work takes place **today (Sunday)** at Henry McLaughlin's Farm.

(From Derry, turn right at Burnfoot.)

- First walkers: 12 noon
- Final walkers: 2.00 pm

Participants are encouraged to check the weather forecast and wear suitable clothing.

Your support is greatly appreciated.

ATU St Angela's

Applications are now open for the **Part-Time Certificate in Religious Education for Primary School**, delivered online from **Autumn 2026**.

The programme is suitable for:

- Qualified primary teachers
- Post-primary teachers transferring to primary education
- Parents
- Sacramental preparation teams
- Parish catechists

Closing Date: 14th August 2026

Further information:

Mary Kearns
Senior Administrator
Education Department
ATU St Angela's
Lough Gill, Sligo

Email:
mary.kearns@atu.ie

Rosary on the Coast

Sunday 5th July

3.00 pm

Lisfannon Beach

Praying for:

- Peace
- Ireland
- Our unborn children

Everyone is most welcome.

Anam Óg Summer Scheme

Termonbacca, Derry

For children aged **8–14 years**

3rd–7th August

12.00 noon – 4.00 pm daily

A week of:

- Faith
- Friendship
- Arts & Crafts
- Adventures
- Games
- Prayer

Email:

termonbaccaderry@ocd.ie

Men's Rosary

The **First Saturday Rosary** will take place on

Saturday 4th July

1.00 pm

Market Square, Letterkenny

All are welcome, especially newcomers.